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Betaworks' third fund closes at \$66M to invest in early-stage AI startups



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- The uproar over Vogue's AI-generated ad isn't just about fashion

Betaworks previously raised a \$46 million Fund II in 2020, and a \$48 million Fund I in 2016. It launched in 2008 as a venture studio, and has since become a staple in the New York City tech ecosystem, launching its Betaworks Camp program in 2016. The firm's other notable investments include Tumblr and Kickstarter.

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Tech and VC heavyweights join the



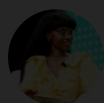
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Dominic-Madori Davis is a senior venture capital and startup reporter at TechCrunch. She is based in New York...

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Ron Palmeri (Moderator)
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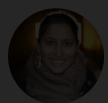
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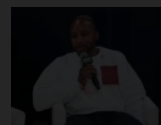
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Twitter is investing at least \$10 million in the new fund, according to one source. We don't know the total size of the venture. In the past, Betaworks has focused on smaller seed investments and has stayed away from outsized funds. Another previous one, for example, was \$8 million. We weren't able to learn if there are any additional participants.

FUNDRAISING

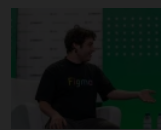


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There's already a connection between Betaworks and Twitter. Betaworks previously invested in two companies that were acquired by Twitter: TweetDeck and Summize. Twitter acquired Summize in 2008, in which Betaworks founder John Borthwick was an investor — through Betaworks. Twitter bought TweetDeck, also backed by Betaworks, for \$40 million in 2011. It also counted itself a Twitter investor.

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For Betaworks, there's a benefit to getting into a new fund that includes Twitter. By default, it gives those startups in the portfolio more exit options: Twitter will already hold a stake and might consider additional investment — or an acquisition.



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talent and to widen their platforms. TechStars worked, until recently, with Disney and still partners with a lot of other larger companies. Funds like this help larger companies get to the front of the line when they want to acquire companies, and gives them insight into tools that might naturally fit into their portfolio of services.

Coincidentally, this week Google also confirmed its own startup fund and incubator — [although its effort, like space](#)

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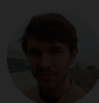


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